

Frost Giants Visit

Khan flies Barrek and I to the whistling peaks. We couldn't find Vivian so we had no choice but to set off without her. We look up at the floating islands that are drifting atop the clouds. There seems to be endless rainfall coming from these clouds. I am informed that these islands were named the Mourning crown. We decide it's best to let Khan fly us up into the clouds, beyond the rainfall.

The skies are packed with floating ice crystals and dense fog. The visibility here is so poor that we can only see normally for about 15 feet and another 20-25 feet of extremely blurry sight. The gravity seemed to work just as usual, thankfully. The wind seems to be blowing in a sort of circling vortex around us, making it easier for us to navigate depending on where the wind's direction is coming from. It is at this point that Vivian joins us, seeing her on her broom flying towards us was a relief. She was the one that started to notice shadows around us. Some appeared as birds, only to end up being ice shards when we moved closer. Others seemed like humanoid shapes that disappeared with the roar of thunder. We eventually find an area with better visibility and see that it is a tunnel. We choose to go to the right and travel in this area for better visibility. The more we travelled through the tunnel we started to notice that the tunnel was slowly collapsing behind us, as if the clouds were filling the space again.

The tunnels itself seemed to have a pattern in them, like they were made by something that was digging through these clouds. The temperature dropped as we entered what looked to be a chamber made from the interior of a cloud. It is here we find remnants of a nest, a water basin made from ice and a place with a snowy mushy layer that looks like a resting place. I find drag marks on the floor and some more evidence of something taking off. It definitely appeared that something still lived here. I made an attempt to make tunnels of my own but the combination of displacing the clouds and making them stay static was too hard of a combination to keep up.

We wanted to get out of there quickly to avoid the inhabitants coming home, so Khan flew us all out of there back into the clouds. I managed to hold on but the wind currents were quite strong. Barrek and Vivian lost their grip and smashed into each other as they dangled from Khan. The safety ropes were the right decision it seemed. This is where I started to feel uneasy. I could feel a storm approaching as we flew up, luckily I anticipated the lightning strikes in time so I could absorb a big part of its energy. It seems to be that this area is made from different layers, each carrying their own dangers. A bit later Vivian spots a fairly big, flat creature flapping through the clouds. It is too hard to see fully with the fog but we avoided it successfully. We press on with Vivian on her broom helping us navigate as I steer Khan by the horns on his helmet where to fly to. While we fly, Barrek is dangling from Khan's leg while doing situps. The man truly is fearless.

Then a form of darkness approaches us from above. I steered Khan out of the way to avoid impact but when it got closer it didn't seem to be solid. Barrek decided to stick his head in for a bit, apparently it was quite warm and comfortable inside. When he came back out he had a plate sized egg stuck in his beard.

Unfortunately, due to the temperature the egg froze over making it impossible to ever grow life. We decided to take two of the eggs out of curiosity, one was being carried by Barrek on his chest like a baby sling, the other was carried by me wrapped in one of Khan's cloaks, tied to my back. These eggs needed all the warmth they could get to survive.

We find evidence of life in the form of remnants of campfires frozen deep inside an iceberg. While I was flying with Vivian on her broom, Barak managed to crash Khan into one of the icebergs. Maybe next time it would be best not to let Barrek drive Khan, as much of a funny sight that it was they could have gotten seriously hurt. Luckily this time the iceberg was more hurt than them as they managed to nearly split the thing down the middle. Inside was some sort of fragment of a telescope lens, it was HUGE.

We find a small island where we decide to set up camp for the night. Barrek managed to fish and successfully caught a sailfish while Khan wanted to hunt for a whale. He didn't find one, however he managed to lure a cloud ray towards us. We fought the thing, with Khan's grapple, Barrek's position on top of it to ride it, and Vivian and I hitting it from a distance. We made quick work of it. To all striders reading it, be careful though. These cloud rays have the ability to stun you, nearly causing Barrek to plummet to his death if I didn't get to him in time. This was also an adult ray, but after inspection we realised there are even bigger ones roaming here.

Hyrrokin and the chariot managed to carry us even further up to a small island where we see 3 buildings. There didn't seem to be people around there so we went higher up to an island where we spotted a fortress city. There's many buildings like an observatory, a smithy, a weather station, a meeting hall, a building with foul smelling smoke coming out of it and many more. We see a giant setting on the side steps of the observatory so we head there. His name is Jorund Sky-Scribe and he is one of the scientists of the frost giants. We make some friendly conversation and he invites us to the meeting hall to speak more comfortably. We meet some other giants there and learn that they have been down on the ground before. Vivian leads the conversation as they exchange some knowledge. We are treated well, even getting a warm meal and ale to refuel. Jorund promised he would propose some kind of diplomacy to the council, if we could make it worth their while. They seem to be folk with lots of knowledge already, so having to prove ourselves to gain their trust fully might prove a difficult task. They supply us with rooms to stay for the night.

The next morning Jorund informs us that the council accepted our proposal but that they will formally need to discuss the terms of the diplomacy. For a second we were glad to have established some sort of an alliance, until it was mentioned that this process would take at least 4 years. At least we made a good start. Jorund tells us a little more about their way of life before we had to leave. We learned that the frost giants are split into 3 main groups; the Ice Bound, the Sky Keepers and the Deep Forged. The Ice Bound are the warriors, the Sky Keepers are the scientists and lastly the Deep Forged serve as the crafters. We also learned the names of the islands. The top island is called Crown Hold. You also have a long curved island called the Shelf, sometimes also referred to as the Scholar Shelf. The Shelf itself has a smaller island that is positioned a bit lower that is called the Storm Wash. The other islands are the Hollow Crown, which is a very unstable island, the Frost Wood, which as the name suggests is a forest island and the First Gem, which is an island covered in some sort of ruins.

He also spoke of an area that is called the Weeping Glacier, but he was quite vague about the location of it. Probably because it is the water source for everything here and there isn't enough trust yet.

Mapping this area will be quite hard as these islands float around and change placements. They stay in their respective areas generally but do sway and move as the winds carry them in certain directions. It was also quite noticeable that it is harder to breathe up here, anything physical we did felt more draining as usual.

We did manage to convince the Sky Keepers to be somewhat open to diplomacy, maybe if we convince the other branches the process will go easier.